

RESKILLING/UPSKILLING Should Be The TOP PRIORITY



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It is a misconception that there are not many core electronics jobs in top IT MNCs. Tech Mahindra's Srinivas Rambabu, head - engineering talent acquisition and special initiatives, and Karthikeyan Natarajan, global head - engineering, the IoT and Industry 4.0, share their inputs on the hiring trends, jobs, skillsets, hiring process, steps to follow and internships at Tech Mahindra with Ankita K.S.

Q. What hiring trends do you see in the electronics industry today?

A. The current trend is towards upskilling/reskilling in emerging niche technologies. Need for specialists and subject matter experts is more than usual.

Programme managers/certified PMP candidates are also required to manage projects to meet schedule, quality and other customer commitments.

Traditional hiring techniques are giving way to hackathons, innovation challenges/workshops and so on.

Also, high volume demand for niche skills makes corporates look at hire-train-deploy (HTD) model with exclusive agreements with third parties.

Product engineers who can handle hardware and firmware, design and development are in demand. Automation is everywhere and, hence, most hiring projections are for candidates with additional skills like Python and machine learning (ML).

Q. Which technology skillsets are in demand today?

A. Such skills as ADAS, AUTO-SAR and CAN/UDS in the automotive electronics domain are in great demand and are expected to increase exponentially in the years to come. Those with skills related to artificial intelligence (AI) and ML are the most sought-after. Embedded C/C++, real-time operating systems, model-based development (MATLAB and Simulink), analogue circuits, mixed circuits, and power electronics design and development are some must-have capabilities that employers are looking for.

Q. What steps should aspirants follow to get a job in the electronics sector?

A. Playing to their strengths should be the approach. Also, going wide in the

chosen domain, while going deep in a couple of chosen areas in that domain.

Q. The Internet of Things (IoT) is an amalgamation of electronics, datacom and IT. Which of these will be the Achilles heel for the IoT sector, in terms of the ready availability of good talent pool?

A. While all three are important skills for the IoT, electronics (control systems) is the mainstay and foundation for this domain. AI, analytics and ML with appropriate domain knowledge are the key elements for the IoT.

Q. How can academic institutions bridge the industry-academia gap?

A. Industry-specific curriculum and specialisation in two or three areas in a domain will help young talent get connected much faster with teams/products soon after they are deployed into projects.

Q. How should academia reinvent the curriculum to create IoT techies?

A. Academia should invest in labs and pilot projects. Training based on systems engineering with live product design and development will enhance students' capabilities.

Academia should collaborate with the industry in designing the curriculum from the first year itself, and for a paid internship from fifth or sixth semester onwards.

They must have specific courses for the IoT, such as products, communications and consumer segment.

Q. Is quality talent a challenge that embedded and IoT players face in India?

A. Yes!

Q. How can those working in core electronics switch to the IoT space?

A. Upskilling/reskilling is the way to go. We are seeing the convergence

of electronics, communications and IT. Candidates need to understand overall project targets, while focussing on their key assignment in specialised areas.

Q. What is the hiring process at Tech Mahindra?

A. We have piloted an AI-based tool to help reduce thirty per cent recruiter bandwidth along with ninety per cent match of profiles with the job description.

We have also implemented HTD model for a few volume requirements of niche skills. Employee referrals are helpful in attracting talent, too.

Q. Do you have a formal internship program for freshers?

A. Yes, we consider interns for live projects based on type of project from the customer and if relevant conditions are met!

Q. Can any student apply for your internship program?

A. Currently, we are not accepting internship applications from students.

Q. What are the mistakes that candidates make? How can they avoid them?

A. They are usually fundamentally weak, and are unclear about their career path. Freshers can start in the manufacturing/product industry, to get a 360-degree view of the entire product development process.

Candidates are largely ignorant about current market trends in their domain. Reskilling/upskilling should be the top priority.

Job-hopping affects long-term career growth. If people want to be leaders, they must spend sufficient time with one company to understand the challenges and how to effectively overcome them. **EFY**